SCORING QUIRKY QUESTIONS

First read through the whole task: the instructions and prompts are at the end.

Before scoring one of the quirky questions, re-read the question that the participants answered, and then skim the responses in the file to get a sense of their variety. The responses are sorted alphabetically.

After skimming through the responses, give each one a rating. In general, funny responses are:

- **funny** (obviously, it makes you smile or laugh)
- **unusual and uncommon** (not a lot of people said it, so it stands out)
- **clever and witty** (creative, well-crafted, insightful, or nicely expressed).

We have four rating categories:

> **1 = Simply not funny**, obvious, common, clichéd, irrelevant, not even trying, sounds like the first thing that comes to mind for most people, "bad."
>
> **2 = A bit funny**, maybe a good twist on a common response, maybe trying a bit harder, "not bad." Better than the 1s, but not worth repeating it to others.
>
> **3 = Funny**, responses that "work" as jokes, step into the "good" level instead of "not bad." Might be worth repeating to others.
>
> **4 = Pretty funny**, the best of the bunch, "great" responses that are clever, original, and simply really good. These are responses that you would want to share with others.

Don't worry about what other raters would say or overthink any single response. It is more important to be consistent with yourself than to try to match someone else's ratings.

We want to avoid giving 1s to almost everything, and we want to give a solid number of 3s and 4s. After rating a task, sort through the high scores and see if any of the 3s should probably be a 4, or vice versa.

Remember:

- no points off for poor grammar or spelling or typos, but the quality of expression matters
- if the response is missing, don't give a rating
- hit SAVE often!

April 16, 2026

WRITING FUNNY ANSWERS TO QUIRKY QUESTIONS

We're interested in the psychology of humor, like how people come up with funny and witty ideas.

For this task, you'll be asked some quirky questions, and your goal is to respond by ***writing funny answers***.

For example, if you were asked, *What is a good way to survive a long, boring meeting?*, your goal would be to come up with a funny answer.

All ways of being funny are welcome. People have different senses of humor, and it's okay if your sense of humor is really "out there."

What you write can be weird, absurd, gross, dirty-minded, bizarre, offensive, random, or whatever, so long as you're trying to come up with something really funny.

So, on the next six pages, you'll read a quirky question, and the task is to come up with a really funny answer to it, like something that your friends would find funny.

There's no time or word limit. You can take as much time or as little time as you like, and what you write can be as short or long as you like. The important thing is to try to be funny.

We're interested in ***your ideas***, not something from Google, AI, or the Internet, so please come up with the ideas on your own.

Click "Next" to start, and have fun with it!

[The items appeared one at a time, like this]

Please come up with a funny answer to this question:

> ***What is an odd choice for a first date activity?***
>
> ***What is an unusual thing to bring to a classroom show-and-tell?***
>
> ***What is the worst gift you can bring to a wedding?***
>
> ***What is a strange theme for a high-school graduation party?***
>
> ***What is a terrible title for a motivational seminar?***
>
> ***What is a good way to make a crowded room go completely silent?***